



Byram Hills High School English Portfolio



Academically Prepared

Demonstrates a strong foundation in the NYS learning standards and is equipped with the knowledge and skills necessary to achieve success in college, careers, civic engagement, service, and life.

Creative Innovator

Utilizes imagination, curiosity, and flexible thinking to solve problems creatively, and develop new ideas and products, while adapting to evolving circumstances and challenges.

Critical Thinker

Analyzes information thoughtfully, evaluates evidence critically, and identifies patterns and connections between different pieces of information (across multiple content areas) to address complex issues and navigate the world with insight.



Effective Communicator

Articulates ideas clearly and confidently through speaking, writing, and the use of different types of media for a variety of purposes, while engaging with diverse audiences and actively listening to different perspectives.

Global Citizen

Acts responsibly and ethically within local, global, and digital communities, employing civic knowledge, skills, and mindsets to promote global sustainability and contribute positively to a culturally diverse, democratic society.

Reflective and Future Focused

Engages in self-reflection to identify strengths and areas for growth, sets meaningful goals, uses social awareness to maintain supportive relationships, and demonstrates responsible decision-making that prioritizes social, emotional, and mental well-being.

Portrait of a Graduate

As ninth graders, students will begin to compile evidence to demonstrate proficiency in each of the seven components defined above. These components represent the newly adopted *New York State Portrait of a College, Career, and Civic Ready Graduate* as outlined in the Blue Ribbon Report and adopted by the Board of Regents in the fall of 2024. The indicators above were revised in the summer of 2025.

At the end of junior year, students will reflect on their growth, reviewing evidence they have collected from their English classes to identify areas of strength and opportunities for continued progress. The final portfolio will serve as a record of the student's college and career readiness in the English Language Arts.



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General Expectations

- Students will create a single digital portfolio—the department recommends using Google Sites or another comparable app—updating it regularly with evidence to showcase their competency in each of the seven required components. Students are welcome to use the template provided by the English department or create an original design.
- The design of the portfolio should reflect a multi-modal approach, including images, videos, podcasts, and presentations, when applicable; students are responsible for making sure that correct permissions are granted so that faculty and staff in the Byram Hills district may view their work.
- Student portfolios will serve as an overarching evaluation of a student's work, with comprehensive evidence and reflective writing that demonstrates self-awareness.
- All portfolios in grades 9-10 will receive grades for completion; at the conclusion of the junior year, the portfolio will receive a final grade based on the attached rubric. This grade will account for ten-percent of the student's final grade in English 11 and a portion of the fourth quarter grade for English 11 AP.

Suggested Evidence

Academically Prepared: speeches, research-based writing, Regents and/or AP Preparation, independent reading

Creative Innovator: speeches, projects, podcasts, peer editing, research-based writing

Critical Thinker analytical paragraphs, expository essays, seminar discussions, literary presentations, creative writing/projects, response to literary criticism, Regents and/or AP preparation

Effective Communicator: speeches, in-class presentations, group projects, podcasts, seminar discussions

Global Citizen: current events presentations, speeches, research-based writing

Reflective and Future Focused: Journaling, independent reading, college essay and narrative writing, reader-response writing, independent reading, current events presentations, projects related to core novels



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Portfolio Rubric

Criteria	Emerging (1 pt)	Developing (2 pts)	Proficient (3 pts)	Advanced (4 pts)
Reflection (3x)	Reflection is superficial or missing. Connections between evidence and growth are unclear or absent.	Reflection demonstrates some awareness of growth over time. Connections between evidence and growth are present but may be general.	Reflection is thoughtful and demonstrates a clear understanding of growth over time. Connections between evidence and growth are specific and well-explained.	Reflection is insightful and demonstrates a deep understanding of growth over time. Connections between evidence and growth are sophisticated and reveal nuanced self-awareness.
Evidence (2x)	Portfolio is missing multiple required components or evidence. Evidence provided is insufficient or irrelevant.	Portfolio is missing some required components or lacks evidence from freshman, sophomore, or junior year. Evidence is generally relevant but may be lacking in depth.	Portfolio includes evidence for all required components with distinct evidence from freshman, sophomore, and junior year. Evidence is relevant and sufficiently developed.	Portfolio includes evidence for all required components with substantial and compelling evidence from freshman, sophomore, and junior year. Evidence is insightful and demonstrates a thorough understanding of the components.
Conventions (1x)	Portfolio contains numerous errors in grammar, mechanics, spelling, and citation. Errors impede readability.	Portfolio contains several errors in grammar, mechanics, spelling, and citation. Errors occasionally distract the reader.	Portfolio contains few errors in grammar, mechanics, spelling, and citations. Errors do not distract the reader.	Portfolio is free of errors in grammar, mechanics, spelling, and citations. Portfolio demonstrates careful attention to detail.



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Conversion Chart

Total Points	Grade
24	A+
22-23	A
21	B+
18-20	B
17	C+
14-16	C
13	D
6-12	F

Note: During the junior year, the English Portfolio will count as ten percent of a student's overall grade in *English 11* and a portion of the quarter four grade in *English 11 AP*.